

JONATHAN BLACKBURN

Founder | Systems Architect | Enterprise Automation & AI Leader

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Battle-tested systems architect and hybrid founder with 20+ years of operational execution across industrial automation, ISO-compliant medical diagnostics, forensic toxicology, and applied artificial intelligence. Proven track record of transforming operational chaos into structured, scalable enterprise ecosystems from bootstrapping a national audio-visual integrator to establishing South Africa's first privately owned forensic toxicology laboratory. Combines deep technical pedigree (React, TypeScript, full-stack architecture) with strict forensic discipline to design connected digital infrastructure that performs under pressure. Core philosophy: chaos is solved by systems, not motivation.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Systems Architecture | Enterprise Automation | AI / ML Strategy | Full-Stack Engineering | Advanced OSINT | Deep-Packet Inspection | Node-Level Origin Tracing | ISO Compliance | LIMS & Data Governance | Forensic Toxicology | Molecular Diagnostics | Business Process Automation | RPA Implementation | Cyber Forensics | Strategic Turnaround | B-BBEE & Transformation | Digital Investigations | Data Intelligence | Electronics Engineering |

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

JB³ (JB³Ai) — Founder & Systems Architect

2025 — Present | Pretoria, South Africa

- Architected modular enterprise operating framework (OS³ Core Platform) integrating robotic process automation (RPA) bots, real-time data pipelines, and centralized business dashboards to eliminate administrative friction and manual repetition for SME founders.
- Designed, developed, and deployed full-stack automation platforms and specialized sub-systems including Clipboard OS³ Lite (collaborative React/Supabase environment) and JB³ VoiceGrid OS³ (intelligent speech routing and communication telemetry layer).
- Constructed graphical visualization engines including JB³ ViewGrid to systematically clean up disconnected file silos, organize multi-feed telemetry layouts, and deliver high-fidelity interaction matrices for complex workflows.
- Established discrete cyber-forensic division deploying air-gapped, physically isolated Financial Investigative AI systems (InvestigatorAi) for cross-border SWIFT data analysis, cryptocurrency tracing (CoinJoin de-mixing), and sovereign asset recovery.
- Pioneered AI-for-good initiatives including MindCareAi, integrating behavioral coaching metrics and team wellness analytics into enterprise workflow design to protect human cognitive margins. JB³ ISIKOLOAi is a fully offline, edge-powered AI tutor tailored to the South African CAPS curriculum. It offers instant, on-device learning support and real-time translation across all 11 official languages without needing an internet connection.

iMED Medical Group - Chief Executive Officer (CEO)

2015 — 2024 | Pretoria, South Africa

- Founded iMED Distributors with minimal seed capital and scaled into a multi-division international medical diagnostics and pharmacology group spanning forensic toxicology, molecular diagnostics, pharmaceutical manufacturing, and DNA analytics.
- Established South Africa's first privately owned, ISO 17025-certified forensic toxicology laboratory, implementing zero-error tolerance protocols, automated 24/7 telemetry networks, and multi-factor biometric access control to guarantee court-defensible outcomes.
- Led historic 23-day sprint deployment of a fully accredited PCR molecular diagnostic facility during the COVID-19 pandemic, managing a national retail pharmacy testing mandate that processed thousands of daily assays with an audited record of exemplary accuracy and zero false results.
- Engineered proprietary 8-panel diagnostic test cassettes calibrated to South Africa's unique substance profile (Nyaope, Wonga, Tik, Khat), eliminating false-positive errors that had previously cost individuals their employment, child custody, and freedom.
- Deployed advanced Laboratory Information Management Systems (LIMS) with immutable chain-of-custody tracking, replacing tampered sample loops with court-admissible BioBox transport frameworks.
- Successfully managed the Led the group through business rescue and eventual closure in 2025 and lifecycle completion of the multi-division group in 2024 following acute post-pandemic macroeconomic friction and national regulatory licensing backlogs, preserving an uncompromised moat of biological data protocols.
- Achieved Level 2 B-BBEE Contributor status and directed employment frameworks focused on training and advancing health scientists from previously disadvantaged communities.
- Formally recognized as national finalist: Top Entrepreneur of the Year (Top Empowerment Awards 2022) and The Entrepreneur Award (Absa Jewish Achiever Awards 2022).

Elite Technologies - Founder & Managing Director

2006 — 2020 | Pretoria, South Africa

- Bootstrapped national audio-visual and automation integration company from door-to-door sales into a premier systems integrator serving mission-critical boardrooms, corporate control rooms, luxury residences, and commercial complexes over 14 years.
- Secured and executed a landmark multi-million upfront corporate performance automation contract for an insurance call center (OUTsurance), hand-assembling an integrated visualization control engine with 40,000 discrete connectors and thousands of meters of cabling; system ran continuously for 8 years with zero hardware failures.
- Mastered real-time control environments, low-latency interactive systems, and multi-room circuit calibration across brands including Crestron, Bose, JBL, Polycom, and StarLeaf; earned CEDIA and SACIA industry accreditations.
- Executed strategic management buyout and employee asset transfer, ensuring seamless operational continuity while pivoting focus to healthcare technology ventures.

Trust in Hope Recovery House - Founder & Director

2015 — 2022 | Pretoria, South Africa

- Established licensed secondary-care recovery facility accommodating up to 24 residents, implementing structured 12-step protocols, career placement counseling, financial accountability frameworks, and feedback-loop systems rooted in the principle that chaos is solved by systems, not hope.

- Self-funded operations during startup phase through cross-subsidization from Elite Technologies, achieving self-sustainability via corporate donations while maintaining zero resident turnover due to financial exclusion.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- Essential DNA Sequencing — DNAbiotec (Pty) Ltd | Nov 2021
- EU Medical Device Regulatory Affairs Explained Simply — Udemy (EUmed) | Oct 2021
- ISO 13485:2016 Medical Device Quality Management Systems — Udemy (Umed) | May 2022
- Certified Quality Management & Quality Assurance Manager — Udemy (ISOinstitute) | Oct 2021
- ISO 9001:2015 QMS Implementation & Auditing Practices — Udemy (ISOinstitute) | Nov 2022
- ISO 9001:2015 Internal Auditor — Udemy (ISOinstitute) | Oct 2021
- Applied ISO 14971 Medical Device Risk Management — Udemy | Oct 2021
- Distribution & Logistics Management — Udemy | Oct 2021
- Music Production & Sound Synthesis — Manchester Midi School, UK | Pre-2006
- High School Matriculation — The Glen High School, Pretoria | Pre-2006

TECHNICAL SKILLS MATRIX

Full-Stack Development & Architecture: React, TypeScript, Vite, Supabase, Google Apps Script, cPanel, Azure, JavaScript, C++, DOS, LLM, JAVA, React, Ubuntu, HTML/CSS and more

Automation & Intelligence: RPA Bots, Power BI, Advanced OSINT Frameworks, Deep-Packet Inspection, Node-Level Origin Tracing, Real-Time Data Pipelines

Compliance & Quality Systems: ISO/IEC 17025:2017, ISO 13485:2016, ISO 9001:2015, ISO 14971, SANAS, SAHPRA, FDA 510K, CE Mark, HIPAA

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

- Top Empowerment Awards 2022 — Finalist: Top Entrepreneur of the Year (iMED Distributors)
- Top Empowerment Awards 2022 — Finalist: Customer Focus Excellence
- Absa Jewish Achiever Awards 2022 — Finalist: The Entrepreneur Award
- Level 1 B-BBEE Contributor — Highest national empowerment designation for structural industry transformation

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- 14+ years continuous verified long-term recovery; instrumental in scaling fellowship programs infrastructure across South Africa.
- Author of Use GTR³ (in progress): a live-documented operational manual codifying 20 years of enterprise scale, market collapse, and structural turnaround into a framework for personal and organizational sovereignty.
- Languages: English (native), Afrikaans (minimal conversational).

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